

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1050

By Martin G

A RESOLUTION to honor Sam Houston on the occasion of his birthday.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we remember those individuals whose lives shaped the history of this State and nation; and

WHEREAS, Samuel Houston, known as Sam Houston, was born on March 2, 1793, in Rockbridge County, Virginia; and

WHEREAS, Sam Houston moved to Tennessee as a young man in 1807, settling in the eastern part of the State near Maryville in Blount County; and

WHEREAS, as a teenager, Mr. Houston left his family and spent three years on Hiwassee Island at the confluence of the Tennessee and Hiwassee rivers; during that time, he was adopted into a Cherokee Indian family and received the name "The Raven" from the chief, and he began his lifetime fascination with classical literature, including Homer's *Iliad* and *The Odyssey*; and

WHEREAS, Sam Houston returned to Maryville in 1812 and opened a one-room schoolhouse, remarking years later that as a teacher, "I experienced a higher feeling of dignity and self-satisfaction than from any office or honor which I have since held."; and

WHEREAS, during the War of 1812, Mr. Houston served bravely under General Andrew Jackson, particularly distinguishing himself at 1814's Battle of Horseshoe Bend, where he was severely wounded yet continued to fight, receiving wounds that would hinder him for the rest of his life; and

WHEREAS, Sam Houston developed a close friendship and mentorship with Andrew Jackson, who supported his political rise, including his election to the United States House of Representatives from Tennessee and later as Governor of Tennessee in 1827; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Houston went on to achieve great glory in leading our sister state of Texas to independence, signing the Texas Declaration of Independence on his birthday, March 2, serving as commander of the Texas Army, and decisively defeating Mexican forces led by General Antonio Lopez de Santa Anna at the Battle of San Jacinto in 1836 in a battle that, although his forces were greatly outnumbered, lasted only eighteen minutes; he then became the first president of the Republic of Texas and later served as a United States Senator from Texas and as Governor of Texas; and

WHEREAS, Sam Houston is the only person ever to be elected as governor of two states; and

WHEREAS, a strong supporter of the Union throughout his life, Mr. Houston opposed secession during the lead-up to the Civil War, and, when Texas seceded in 1861, he refused to take an oath of allegiance to the Confederacy, allowing the Texas legislature to remove him from office rather than betray his principles and bring civil strife to his adopted state; and

WHEREAS, Sam Houston's actions during this pivotal moment in American history reflect the strength of his convictions and the depth of his dedication to public service; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor Sam Houston on the occasion of his birthday, March 2, recognize his distinguished service to the State of Tennessee and to the nation, and reflect upon his enduring contributions to American history.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.